

Everyone's getting on to the SMS bandwagon—here's how you can join in the fun!

ANIL PATRICK R.

If 'expensive teeny-weeny messages that yuppies send back and forth on their mobiles' is what you think SMS (Short Message Service) refers to, then you're only partly correct. You can easily send an SMS text message to your friend's mobile even if you don't have one. And the story doesn't end with text messages on mobiles!

Getting on the SMS highway

Get the basic information on the required tools. For this, check out the box, 'SMS Funda Pack'. Okay, now that you have the basics right, you can choose how you want to send the SMS. Do you want to send the message from a Web site or

would you rather use your trusted instant messenger (IM)? Both these services have their pros and cons. Web sites offer features such as tracking whether or not your SMS has been delivered. However, there is always the risk of your cell phone number being marketed. IMs are generally more secure when it comes to this aspect. However, most of them do not have tracking features—you have to rely on providence with most IMs.

SMS via e-mail

Nowadays, most cellular operators allow e-mail messages to be sent to users. The usual e-mail address of the user is in the form, number@provider.com. For example, if you want

Imaging: Ashwin Boricha

THE LONG and SHORT of it

